Paired inverse (lever 2): same-session A/B with its own A/A

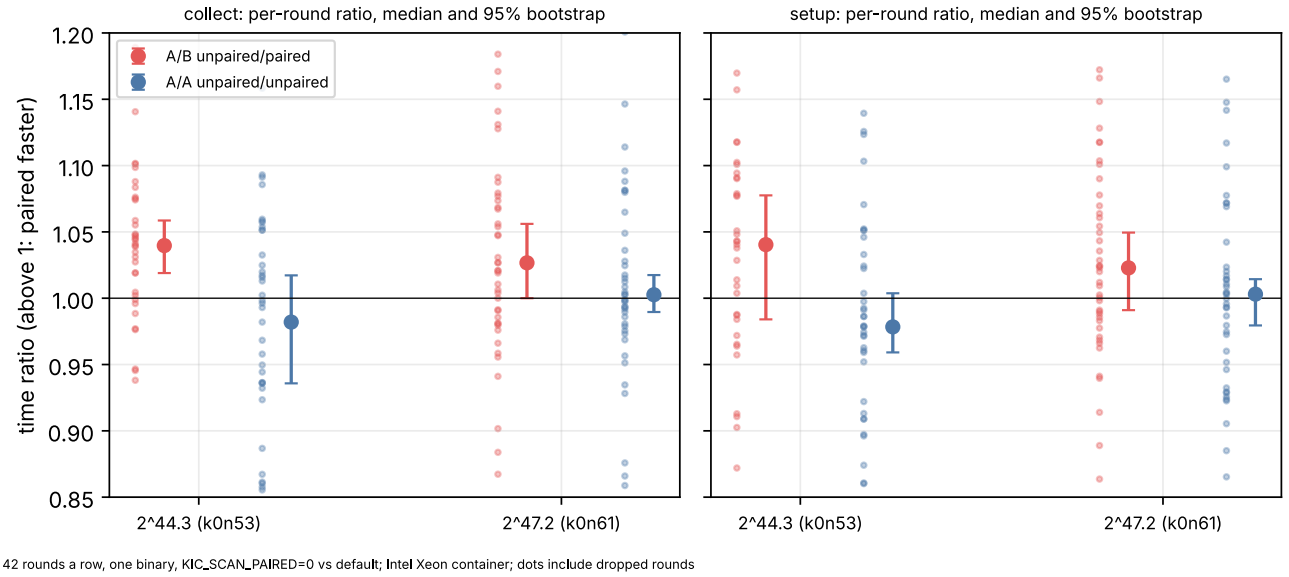
One `ic` binary (`21b0a4f7…`, built at `064334a304`). Three labels a round: **a** and **q**, unpaired (`KIC_SCAN_PAIRED=0`, today's path); **c**, paired (the default). Rows: suite `M1-T01` at `k0n53` (2^44.3) and `k0n61` (2^47.2). 42 rounds, with the order cycled over the six permutations. Each process ran under `isolated_bench --cpus 2` with `RAYON_NUM_THREADS=1` on this session's container (Intel Xeon @ 2.1 GHz, AVX-512, VPCLMULQDQ, GFNI). `PROTOCOL.md` was committed before any row. Container restarts stopped the session twice; it resumed from its rows with nothing redone. Class: engineering. Every output is identical by construction and by check.

Identity

Zero mismatches: every process of a row gave the same certificates and counts. Dropped rounds (contended): k0n53 3, k0n61 1.

Result (median of per-round ratios, 95% bootstrap over rounds, exact LCG, high-bit index)

row	metric	A/B a/c	A/A a/q	verdict	prediction
k0n53	collect	**1.040** [1.019, 1.059]	0.982 [0.936, 1.017]	**established**	[1.02, 1.08]: held
k0n53	set-up	1.040 [0.984, 1.078]	0.978 [0.959, 1.004]	not established	[1.00, 1.05]
k0n61	collect	1.027 [1.000, 1.056]	1.003 [0.990, 1.017]	not established	[1.05, 1.13]: missed
k0n61	set-up	1.023 [0.991, 1.049]	1.003 [0.979, 1.014]	not established	[1.03, 1.10]



42 rounds a row, one binary, KIC_SCAN_PAIRED=0 vs default; Intel Xeon container; dots include dropped rounds

Reading

- **Collect, k0n53:** the paired kernel is faster in the collect phase by about 4%, and the interval's lower end clears the A/A's upper end by 0.002. That is the only established effect.
- **Collect, k0n61:** the median is 2.7%, but its interval touches 1. The exploration's −9.8% there (three processes an arm) did not reproduce.
- **Whole set-up:** not established at either size. The build and selection phases add noise of the same order as the gain.
- **What it is:** a component result on this host class. It is not a cold-time claim against rho, and no board row follows from it.